provinces (b) the withdrawal of Sri Lankan troops to their northern barracks and (c) the disarmament of the Tamil rebels.

Starting 30 July 1987, Indian army troops started getting stationed in Sri Lanka to watch over the regional council. At its peak, the IPKF deployment included a large Indian paramilitary force, the Indian special forces, the Indian air force and the Indian navy. Though no Tamil militant groups were part of the peace negotiations, most accepted it. The LTTE, on the other hand, declared war on the IPKF on 7 October 1987.[3] Following an assault on the IPKF, which led to the death of five Indian para-commandos, the Indian army launched a month-long ruthless anti-LTTE campaign to regain control of the Jaffna peninsula. The intervention of the IPKF was opposed by the Sri-Lankan Tamils and the Sinhalese alike. The IPKF launched a number of combat operations aimed at destroying the LTTE-led insurgency. It soon escalated into repeated skirmishes between the IPKF and LTTE.[4]

Following his election as President, Ranasinghe Premadasa started negotiations with the LTTE and ordered the Sri Lankan army to discreetly hand over a consignment of arms to the LTTE to fight the IPKF. Following tactical success but several intelligence failures, the IPKF started leaving the country. In its wake were left a string of controversies and accusations that gained traction even after the last members left Sri Lanka by March 1990.